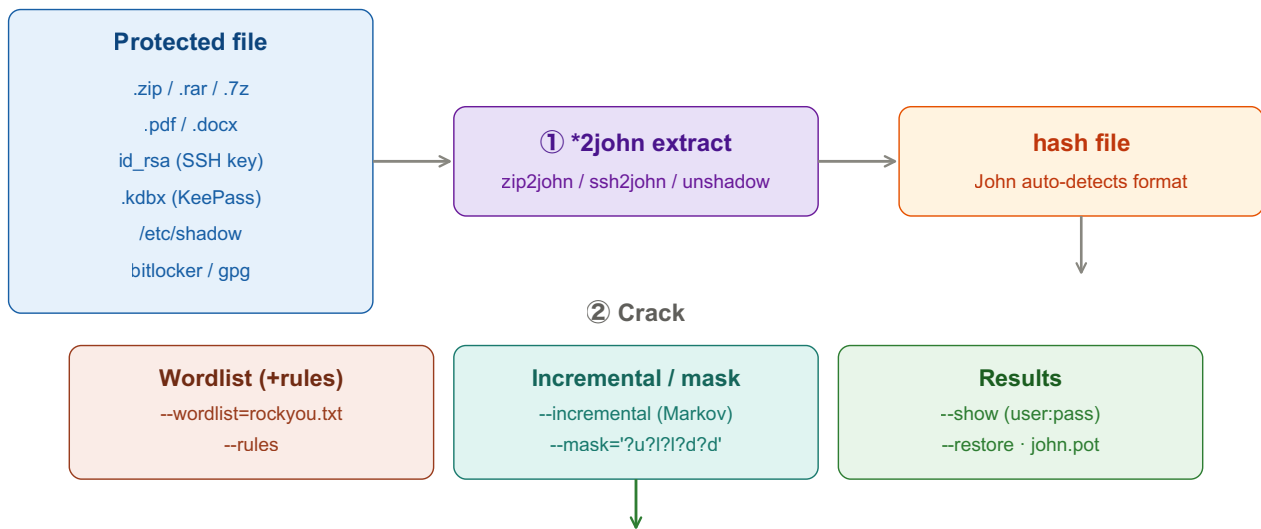


John the Ripper

Crack hashes with John (jumbo). Its edge: 100+ *2john tools that turn protected files (zip/PDF/SSH key/KeePass/shadow) into crackable hashes, plus auto-format detection. Pairs with hashcat — John for wrangling + CPU, hashcat for GPU speed. Replace <placeholders> with your own values.



John = breadth (file formats + auto-detect, CPU).

Hashcat = raw GPU speed on slow hashes. Extract with *2john, crack with either.

① Extract a Hash with *2john

Turn a protected file into a crackable hash — 100+ extractors ship with jumbo John.

Tab 1 · Extract

```
zip2john secret.zip > zip.hash
rar2john secret.rar > rar.hash
pdf2john.pl doc.pdf > pdf.hash
ssh2john id_rsa > ssh.hash           # SSH key passphrase
keepass2john db.kdbx > kp.hash
office2john report.docx > office.hash
unshadow /etc/passwd /etc/shadow > linux.hash    # Linux local accounts (root)
```

Also: 7z2john, bitlocker2john, gpg2john, and many more.

② Wordlist Crack (auto-detect)

Tab 2 · Crack

```
john --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt <hashfile>
john --show <hashfile>                # cracked user:password

# force a format if needed:
john --list=formats | grep -i <keyword>
john --format=krb5tgt --wordlist=rockyou.txt <hashfile>    # e.g. kerberoast
```

③ Rules, Incremental & Mask

Tab 3 · Modes

```
john --wordlist=rockyou.txt --rules <hashfile>
john --wordlist=rockyou.txt --rules=Jumbo <hashfile>
john --incremental <hashfile>          # smart brute (Markov)
john --mask='?u?l?l?l?l?d?d' <hashfile>    # hashcat-style mask
```

④ Manage Runs & End-to-End

Tab 4 · Manage

```
john --status                # progress
john --restore                # resume interrupted session
john --users=<user1,user2> <hashfile>
# cracked stored in ~/.john/john.pot (reused automatically)

# full chains:
ssh2john id_rsa > h && john --wordlist=rockyou.txt h    # → ssh -i id_rsa
keepass2john db.kdbx > h && john --wordlist=rockyou.txt h
```

*John vs hashcat: John wins on file-format breadth + auto-detect + CPU convenience; hashcat wins on GPU speed for slow hashes (bcrypt, AES tickets, WPA). Extract with *2john, crack with whichever is faster.*

Key idea: John's edge is breadth — it turns almost any password-protected artifact into a hash with a *2john tool and figures out the format for you, so you spend time cracking, not wrangling. Reach for John when you have an encrypted zip/PDF/SSH key/KeePass to open; reach for hashcat when you need raw GPU throughput on a slow hash.